INCH-POUND

A-A-54674
22 June 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BOX, PATHOLOGICAL SPECIMEN SHIPPING, INSULATED

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-B-36408B which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers one type of polystyrene foam insulated box with a two-handled carrying strap, suitable for storage and shipment of frozen or refrigerated medical specimens and biologicals in dry or wet ice.

Salient characteristics:

General. Shall be a 2 cubic foot capacity rectangular insulated shipping container made of one piece molded polystyrene foam. A detachable plugged lid made of same material shall be fitted at the top. When the lid is secured to the body, the plug section shall form a snug fit with the inside walls of the body. The entire container and the lid shall be encased with laminated fiberboard secured onto the foam surface with adhesive.

The carrying strap harness shall be provided on the outside of the fiberboard. The harness shall consist of three parts: one vertical sling strap to be fitted around the height of the box, one horizontal sling strap to be fitted around the girth of the box and two loop straps used for carrying - one on each side of the box, to be sewn onto the vertical sling strap. Both sling strap ends shall have a one-bar or a two-bar metal tongueless type buckle secured in a loop formed by the webbing of the strap. The other strap ends shall be terminated with an end clip to prevent raveling. The vertical and horizontal sling straps shall be sewn together at the intersecting areas. All sewing shall be accomplished in box tack style.

AMSC N/A FSC 8115

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Material. The polystyrene foam for the body and lid shall have a density of not less than 1-3/4 pound per cubic foot and the maximum thermal conductivity (K factor) is 0.23BTU/sq.ft/hr./^{o}F/inch' at 75°F. The laminated fiberboard shall be 80-point weight with off-white marble color outside. The laminates shall be bonded with a water-resistant adhesive resin. The webbing material shall be black in color and shall be made with cotton or polypropylene strands. When using cotton webbing, it shall be treated with mildew resistant compound and water repellent. The metal buckles and end clips shall be suitably protected from corrosion and shall have a black finish that is not tacky.

Style, design and dimensions. The container shall have a capacity of 2 cu. ft. nominal with inside opening approximately 17 inches square and at least 13-3/8 inches in depth. It shall be able to carry the content up to 75 lbs. without distortion nor breaking. The webbing shall be 1-1/2 inches in width and possess a minimum breaking strength of 440 pounds. Minimum thickness for the container shall be not less than 2 inches. The lid construction shall have the integrally molded plug section to be extended at least 5/8 inch from top of the container body.

The carrying strap harness on the shipping container shall have the two handles positioned so that they are located on opposite sides of the container at a level below the top of the lid.

The fiberboard closures shall be stapled at the corners. The container shall be leakproof and shall have no signs of leakage, when filled with water to the top at upright position, for 24 hours.

Identification marking. The name or registered trademark of the manufacturer shall be permanently and legibly marked on the exterior of each box.

Workmanship. The foam container, carrying strap harness, and fiberboard covering shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One pathological specimen shipping box, as specified, constitutes one unit.

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QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspection and testing. Inspection and testing shall be conducted on the pathological shipping box in accordance with commercial practice. The sampling for inspection and testing shall be in accordance with commercial practices.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

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Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification
8115-00-226-1199	BOX, PATHOLOGICAL SPECIMEN, SHIPPING, INSULATED, PLASTIC, 2 cu. ft.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 8115-0527

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	A-A-54674	22 JUNE 1992

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
BOX, PATHOLOGICAL SPECIMEN SHIPPING, INSULATED

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (*Last, First, Middle Initial*)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (*Include Zip Code*)	d. TELEPHONE (*Include Area Code*) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (*If applicable*)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (*Include Area Code*)	
Defense Personnel Support Center	(1) Commercial (215) 737-2870	(2) AUTOVON 444-2870
c. ADDRESS (*Include Zip Code*) ATTN: MSE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145.	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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0102-LF-000-2700

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